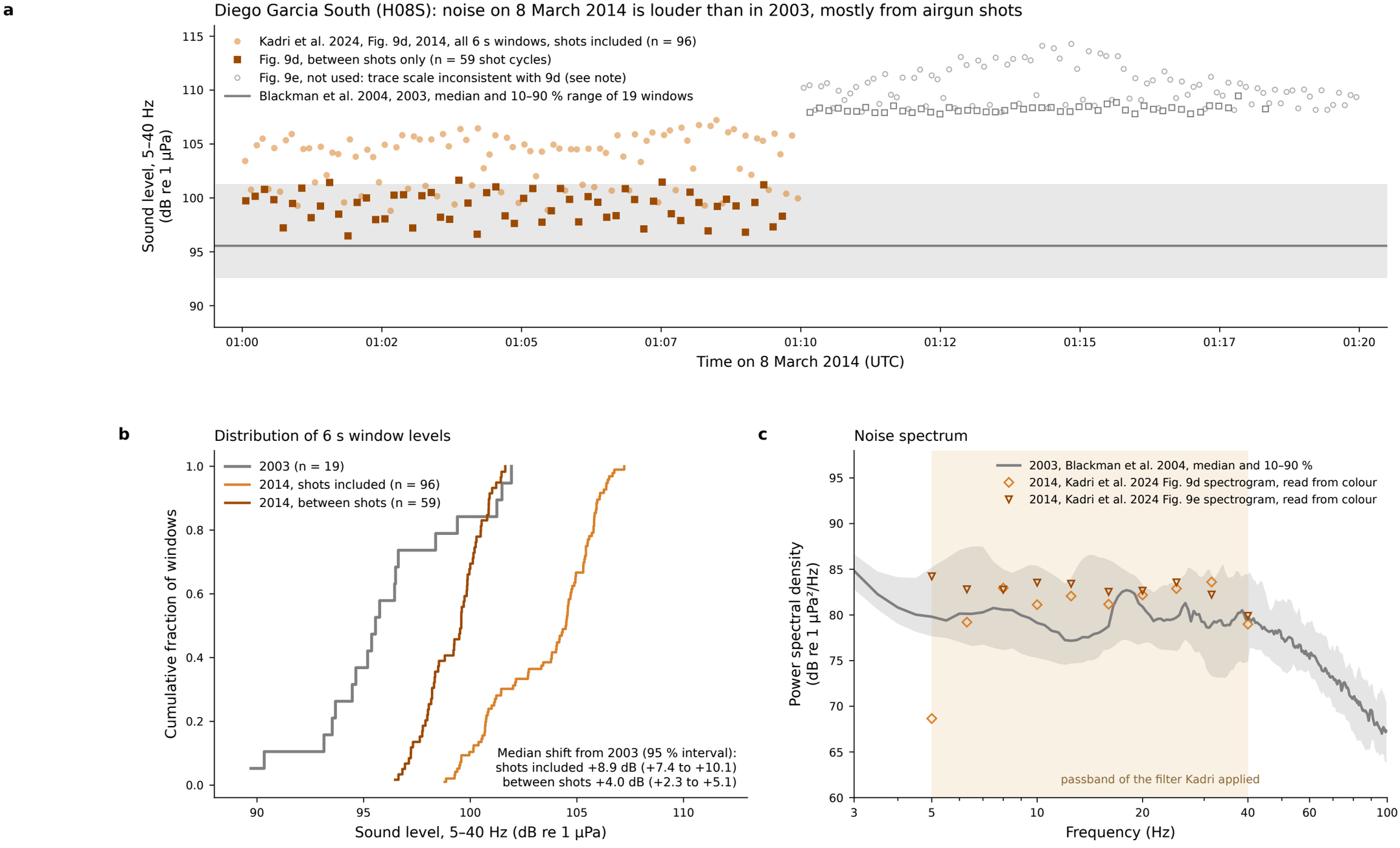

Plain note: The marks show the level of background sound at the Diego Garcia South listening station. Grey is 2003, traced from Blackman et al. (2004). Orange is 8 March 2014, from the trace in Kadri et al. (2024). In 2014 a regular pulse occurs about every 10 s, which agrees with a ship doing an airgun survey. With these pulses, 2014 is about 9 dB louder than 2003. Between the pulses it is about 4 dB louder. The second 2014 panel (open marks) is not used, because its level changes by 9 dB exactly where the two panels meet.

Technical note: 5–40 Hz band level per 6.25 s window (filled circles) and per shot cycle between shots (squares: from 4.5 s after a shot to 1.25 s before the next; the stacked shot energy is > 1 dB above the gap level from −1.0 to +4 s). Shot times: h08s_cycles.csv (107 cycles, 9.98 s period). 2003: Blackman et al. 2004 App. B, 19 quality-checked panels, IM.H08S1 FDSN response, May–June 2003. 2014: Kadri et al. 2024 Fig. 9d (01:00–01:10) vector trace (5 Hz high-pass plus 2–40 Hz band-pass); min/max plot decimation corrected by RMS/1.954 (simulated, ±0.2 dB). Fig. 9e (01:10–01:20) between-shot level steps from 98.3 to 108.1 dB (1 min medians) exactly at the panel join and then stays flat, while Kadri's own spectrogram reading of 9d and 9e agrees within about 1 dB; the 9e trace scale is therefore treated as inconsistent and 9e is excluded from absolute levels. Spectrogram points: JPEG colour reading, 64 dB colour floor, biased low. Shift = 2014 median − 2003 median: shots included +8.9 dB (95 % interval +7.4 to +10.1), between shots +4.0 dB (+2.3 to +5.1); bootstrap as for H01W. At H01W the Kadri trace reads 2.8 dB above the Royer spectrogram at the same time; if the same offset applies here, the between-shot excess is about +1.2 dB. No H08S recording other than Kadri's figure is held.